references in it to problems with the Social Security system. Social Security, of course, was an issue dear to the hearts of many older voters, and Barry said he had spent almost a year denying Democratic claims that he wanted to do away with it. Some members of his staff, he said, thought my speech would bring up the touchy question all over again and set back their efforts to neutralize the issue.

In the speech, I had strongly supported the concept of Social Security, but I argued that improvements were needed in it—pointing out, for example, that Americans had been deceived regarding the security of their money that was deducted from their paychecks to pay for Social Security benefits. For years we'd all been told that we were contributing to an old-age insurance fund that was being set aside for our retirement years, but, in fact, there was no "fund" at all; it had become a compulsory tax producing revenues Congress could—and did—use for any purpose it wanted, while letting the reserves needed for future benefits fall $298 million in the hole.

"Barry," I said, "I've been making the speech all over the state for quite a while and I have to tell you, it's been very well received, including whatever remarks I've made about Social Security. I just can't cancel the speech and give away the airtime; it's not up to me. These gentlemen raised the money and bought the airtime. They're the only ones who could cancel or switch it."

"Well," Barry said, "I haven't heard or seen the speech yet; they've got a tape here, so I'll run it and call you back."

Barry was campaigning someplace in the East, Cleveland I think, and my brother, whose advertising agency was working on his campaign, was part of a group that was traveling with him and so he was there when this was all happening.

According to my brother, who told me about it later, Barry hung up after talking with me and then he and the members